Lebanese Arabic Phrasebook

Vol. 1

HIBA NAJEM

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DEDICATION

While living in Beirut, I have had the chance to meet a lot of foreigners who visit the country each for his/her own different reason. Many of them were struggling with the language, since the Fusha, which they had made a lot effort to learn, didn't seem to help. (The modern standard Arabic or Fusha is a very decent and eloquent language that unites, and is the official language of, all the Arab countries.) The reason for that struggle is that every Arab country has its own dialect that differs from Fusha.
If your destination is Lebanon, than I recommend this book in order to feel free and confidant talking with the locals.
For the love of my country, which is sometimes very hard to love but at the same time very hard to leave, I dedicate my book to my language and to everyone who is willing to learn it.

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PREFACE

Some of you might have purchased this book because you already know me through my Lebanese Arabic teaching videos on Youtube. This book could be considered as an accompanying workbook for the Youtube channel "hiibanajem", as well as an independent Lebanese Arabic phrasebook for new students. The channel consists of a number of videos in which I teach the Lebanese Arabic dialect. It has been around since January 2011, and at the time of writing this book, there are around 50 videos available for everyone to watch.

The purpose of this book is not only to organize all the material taught on the channel throughout the many lessons and to provide a written reference for the students who already have watched the videos, but also to offer new students a more structured access to the material where they could learn the dialect and use the videos as additional guides to deepen their understanding. The last section of this book will consist of language puzzles such as crosswords, word search and fill-in-the-blanks that will help you master the material.

1 INTRODUCTION

The method of teaching is vaguely inspired by the Rosetta Stone method that teaches the dialect through using practical sentences instead of memorizing strict grammatical rules.

All the words and phrases are transcribed from the videos, so there will be a reference to the relevant video below each sentence. You will be able to hear the correct pronunciation in order to master your accent and find detailed explanations of each word in complicated phrases.

The sentences will be divided into themes like "Introductions" or "Travelling" and they will be written in 3 forms:

1. In English first.
2. Then in Lebanese transliteration (Latin alphabet) for people who can't read Arabic.
3. And eventually in Lebanese (Arabic alphabet) for those who are Arabic literate.

Transliteration Guidelines

Since the Arabic alphabet is quite different from the Latin one that does not include the same letters, we'll have to agree upon certain rules that we'll use throughout the book as to avoid any confusion. The representations chosen will be based on their simplicity in contrast with the academic but more complex symbols such as [ʔ] or (ħ). There will be a table presenting each letter and its transliterated representation, preceded by an explanation of some of the letters used. While the table might only be useful for Arabic readers, the explanation will help all readers to recognize the sounds of the transliteration. If any of the following information seems too complicated for you, don't worry, you will find it to be simpler as you go along and read the actual words and phrases. These are just guidelines you can refer to if you find any difficulty in reading transliterations:

1. The Hamza (ء) which is a glottal stop, is not a full letter and is not one of the 28 letters of the alphabet but it is widely used in the language and especially in the Lebanese dialect, as in most Lebanese areas, the Qaf (ق) (pronounced as a "K" or a "Q" in standard Arabic) is pronounced as a Hamza and labeled as a glottal stop. The Hamza is phonetically represented as /ʔ/ while academically represented as a "modifier letter right half ring" (ʾ) which will be replaced by an apostrophe in this book (ʾ). You might find it to be represented with the number (2) on the web, as this is the conventional chatting representation of it, inspired by the inverted similarity in shape of the (2) and the (ء).

2. The Aleph (ا), the first letter of the Arabic alphabet, takes many forms, depending on its accentuation

and on the placement of the Hamza in relation to it, facts that change the way it sounds. It might sound as a glottal stop or as a long vowel. For this reason, in cases where it sounds as a glottal stop it will be transliterated as a simple Hamza (ʿ) and in cases where it sounds like a vowel, it will be represented with the respective vowels (a), (e), (i), (o), or (ei). The latter, (ei), is used as the sound of the accentuated letter (é).

3. Thaa' (ث), is an Arabic letter that sounds like (th) in English words like (th)ink or ba(th), but in the Lebanese dialect it is most commonly replaced by either a (t) or an (s) sound. So it might be written in words as a (ث), but pronounced as is written in the Transliteration. (Ex: Snow=Talej= ثلج)

4. The Arabic letter (ع) or Ayn has no similar letters or sounds in the Latin alphabet. It is articulated with the back of the throat and the root of the tongue. It is phonetically represented as /ʕ/, while its academic representation is the "modifier letter left half ring" (ʿ) which is similar to the representation of the Hamza. In order to avoid any confusion between the Hamza and the Ayn, the latter will be represented as it is in chatting forums with the number (3) because of its mirrored resemblance to (ع) "3ayn".

5. Ghayn (غ) is a variant of 3ayn (ع) in shape but is different in sound. The closest popular equivalent to its sound is the Parisian French (r). It is phonetically represented as /ɣ/ but most commonly

transliterated as (gh) which we will use throughout the book.

6. The Haa' (ح) which is similar to the 3ayn in articulation (with the back of the throat and the root of the tongue) but different in phonation is represented phonetically as /ħ/ and academically as (ḥ) while in this book it will be represented as a capital (H) which is usually the simplest symbol of the Haa'. You might find that it is sometimes written as a (7) because of the number's resemblance to the upper part of (ح).

7. The Khaa' (خ) is pronounced in a way that is very similar to German, Scottish, and Polish (ch), Russian (x), and Spanish (j). It is phonetically represented as /x/, while its most common transliteration is (kh) which is used almost everywhere and is therefore used in this book. You might also find it to be represented as (5) which also resembles a distorted mirrored (خ) missing the dot.

8. Thaal (ذ) and Thahh (ظ) which are variant of each other, and resemble the sound of the English (th) in (th)is or fea(th)er, is most commonly replaced by either a (d) or a (z). Ex: Memory=Zeikra= ذاكرة)

9. Finally, some words end with the sound (é), or might have this sound in the middle of the word. These will be transliterated as (eh) in the end, and (ei) in the middle.

As for the Lebanese words written in the Arabic alphabet, words ending with the (a) sound in Lebanese

will be written:

1. as (ا) whenever the same word in Modern Standard Arabic end with (اء) or (مَا) like حَمراء or عَندها, written as حَمرا or عَندا
2. as (ة) whenever the word is feminine and has a masculine version, like رايحة
3. otherwise, they will be seen as (ه)

The Arabic Letters and Their Transliteration According To the Lebanese Dialect

ا	a|i|o|e|ei
ب	b
ت	t
ث	t|s
ج	j
ح	H
خ	kh
د	d
ذ	d|z
ر	r
ز	z
س	s
ش	sh
ص	s
ض	d
ط	t
ظ	d|z
ع	3
غ	gh
ف	f
ق	‘
ك	k
ل	l
م	m
ن	n
ه	h
و	w|ou
ي	i|y

The Chapters

There are seven chapters in this book. The first six define categories of the phrases taught throughout the chapters, while the last one is dedicated for language exercises and puzzles.

The first chapter entitled "Basic Language" contains five subcategories: Numbers, Colors, Days, Pronouns and Prepositions.

The second chapter, "Travelling", offers sentences that you will need if you are travelling to Lebanon and the subcategories are arranged by what you might chronologically use: Airport, Directions, Money, Accommodation and Shopping.

The third, fourth and fifth chapters will contain everyday sentences as well as phrases to use around friends, family and in relationships and conjugations of a few verbs that might be useful. They will also shed light on how conjugation works in the Lebanese Arabic dialect.

The sixth is the last chapter containing phrases. It will have a variation of random sentences, uncategorized, which I have been asked to teach by viewers of the videos or which I have found to be practical and fun to be learnt.

The final chapter, as mentioned above, will consist of "fill in the blank" exercises, as well as crosswords and word search puzzles. If you wish to print many copies of the puzzles, or probably wish to enlarge them, please sign up at the following link for a PDF version of the puzzles and their solutions: **http://bit.ly/ExercisesPDF** Just enter the link in the address bar of your internet browser and hit the Enter button.

2 CHAPTER 1: BASIC LANGUAGE

Numbers

Zero	صِفر **sefer** *Video Lesson 4*
One	واحد **waHad** *Video Lesson 4*
Two	تنَين **tnein** *Video Lesson 4*
Three	تلاتِه **tleiteh** *Video Lesson 4*
Four	أربعَه **arb3a** *Video Lesson 4*

Five	خمسه **khamseh** *Video Lesson 4*
Six	سِتّه **setteh** *Video Lesson 4*
Seven	سَبعَه **sab3a** *Video Lesson 4*
Eight	تمانه **tmeineh** *Video Lesson 4*
Nine	تسعه **tes3a** *Video Lesson 4*
Ten	عشره **3ashra** *Video Lesson 4*

Days

Monday	تَنين **tanein** Video Lesson 14
Tuesday	تَلاتَه **taleita** Video Lesson 14
Wednsday	أُربِعا **orb3a** Video Lesson 14
Thursday	خَميس **khamees** Video Lesson 14
Friday	جمعه **jem3a** Video Lesson 14
Saturday	سَبت **sabet** Video Lesson 14
Sunday	أَحَد **aHad** Video Lesson 14

Today	اليَوم **lyom** Video Lesson 7
Today is Monday	اليوَم التَنَين **lyom el tanein** Video Lesson 7
Morning	صُبح **sobeH** Video Lesson 7
Noon	ضُهر **doher** Video Lesson 7
Night	لَيل **leil** Video Lesson 7
Moon	أَمَر **amar** Video Lesson 19
Sun	شَمس **shames** Video Lesson 21
Autumn	خَريف **khareef** Video Lesson 7

Winter	شِتي **sheteh** Video Lesson 7
Spring	رَبيع **rabee3** Video Lesson 7
Summer	صَيف|صَيفيه **sayf | sayfiyeh** Video Lesson 23
We are now in the spring	نِحنا هَلَء بِفَصل الربيع **neHna halla' b fasl el rabee3** Video Lesson 7
It's sunny but it's not very hot	في شَمس ومِش كتير شوب **fi shames w mesh kteer shob** Video Lesson 7
In the summer we go to the beach	بالصَيف مِن روح عَلى البَحر **bl seif mn rouH 3al baHer** Video Lesson 7
The sun is setting	الشَمس عَم بتغيب **el shames 3am betgheeb** Video Lesson 7

Colors

Red	حَمرا/ أَحمَر **Hamra/aHmar** Video Lesson 22
Green	خَضرا/ أَخضَر **khadra/akhdar** Video Lesson 22
Blue	زَرقا/ أَزرق **zar'a/azra'** Video Lesson 22
Yellow	صَفرا/ أَصفَر **safra/asfar** Video Lesson 22
Black	سَودا/ أَسوَد **sawda/aswad** Video Lesson 22
White	بَيضا/ أَبيَض **bayda/abyad** Video Lesson 22
Grey	رمَادي **rmeideh** Video Lesson 22

Purple	بَنَفسَجي **banafsajeh** Video Lesson 22
Pink	زَهري **zahreh** Video Lesson 22
Brown	بِنِّي **benneh** Video Lesson 22
Red balloon	بَالون أَحمَر **balon aHmar** Video Lesson 'Valentine'
Red flower	وردِه حَمرا **wardeh Hamra** Video Lesson 'Valentine'

Pronouns

I	أنا **ana** Video Lesson 13
You	إنتِ/إنتَ **enteh/enta** Video Lesson 13
He	هوّي **howeh** Video Lesson 13
She	هيّي **hiyeh** Video Lesson 13
We	نِحنا **neHna** Video Lesson 13
You (plural)	إنتو **ento** Video Lesson 13

They	هنّي **henneh** Video Lesson 13

Prepositions

And	وَ **wa** Video Lesson 10
So	فَ **fa** Video Lesson 10
But	بَس **bas** Video Lesson 10
To (location)	عَلى **3ala** Video Lesson 10
To (cause)	تَ **ta** Video Lesson 10
After	بعدين **ba3dein** Video Lesson 10

When	لمَّا **lamma** Video Lesson 10
From	مِن **men** Video Lesson 10
On	عَلى **3ala** Video Lesson 10
About	عَن **3an** Video Lesson 10
That	إنّو **enno** Video Lesson 10
Because	لأنّو **la'enno** Video Lesson 10

So finally we agreed on the red color	فَأخيرا" إتفأنا على اللَّون الأحمَر **fa akheeran ttafa'na 3ala el lon el aHmar** Video Lesson 10
I would like to come but I'm traveling	عَبالي إجي، بَس مسافرة/مسافَر **3abeileh ejeh, bas msefra/msefar** Video Lesson 10
She's going to the gym	هِيّي رايحة عَلى النادي **hiyeh rayHa 3al neideh** Video Lesson 10
Eat the sandwich then the chocolate	كول العروس بعدين الشوكولا **kol el 3arous ba3dein el chocola** Video Lesson 10
I will call you when I get back	بحكيك لمَّا إرجَع **beHkeek lamma erja3** Video Lesson 10

I buy milk from the supermarket	أنا بشتري حَليب مِن السوبرماركت **ana beshtereh Halib men el supermarket** Video Lesson 10
My book is on the table	كتابي عَلى الطاوله **kteibeh 3ala el tawleh** Video Lesson 10
I'm talking about last night	عَم بحكي عَن مبارِح **3am beHke 3an mberiH** Video Lesson 10
He said that he will come	هوّي آل إنّو جايي **howe 'aal enno jeyeh** Video Lesson 10
He said that she's coming	هوّي آل إنّا جايي **howeh 'aal enna jeyeh** Video Lesson 10

I am here because I lost my baggage	أنا هون لأنّو ضَيَّعت غراضي|شِنطي **ana hon la'enno dayya3et ghradeh|shenateh** Video Lesson 10